

Anthropology 151

Emerging Humanity

Online Asynchronous

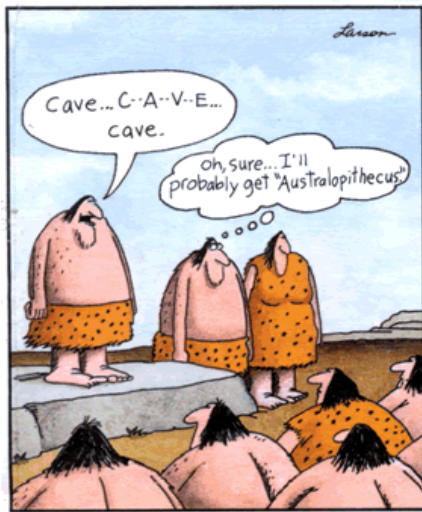
Instructor: Daniel Cusimano

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Office: Saunders 330

Office Hours: M/W 10:00-11:00

Available for Zoom meetings (email for scheduling)



Primitive spelling bees

COURSE DESCRIPTION: Emerging Humanity is a course designed to provide students with a broad understanding of how we, as humans, got to where we are today. We thus step through time to engage in key moments of our biological and cultural evolution in this course's three units. Unit one, unsurprisingly, starts with our evolutionary history. Students will learn about fossil populations, human adaptations, and the emergence of material culture. Unit two explores how our species, *Homo sapiens* spread across the globe with cultural innovations such as agriculture and the political economy. Our final unit dives into the emergence of complex societies ultimately leading to where we are today. This class engages with the four primary sub-fields of anthropology (Biological Anthropology, Archaeology, Linguistics, and Cultural Anthropology), and therefore also provides students with an

idea of what pursuing an anthropology career/degree could look like.

- **REQUIRED TEXTS:**

-Explorations: An Open Invitation to Biological Anthropology

<https://explorations.americananthro.org/>

-Journal Articles will be available for download throughout the course

- **PRESENTATION:** As an online asynchronous course there is not much that can be done for presentation. In the past I have recorded my lectures for students to watch but...let's be real, watching a couple of 45-minute lectures over a variety of Power Points is not likely to happen. Not for the majority at least. So here's the plan: no structured presentation. This puts a lot of responsibility on you to keep up with the reading and a lot of responsibility on me to provide you with some additional content to help explain difficult concepts (and attempt to make the material more interesting for you).

To help with this, I am developing an additional, somewhat more flexible course website for us. This site will provide students with reading notes and supplemental information and sometimes be your primary source for reading throughout the term. Follow the link below.

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- **COURSE REQUIREMENTS:** Other than reliable internet access, the only thing that you will have to be able to use is PowerPoint or equivalent slide presentation builder (See Exams section below).
 - Power Point- You will need to be able to build a presentation and add presenter notes
 - Google Slides- This is a free alternative to PowerPoint that I am less familiar with. From what I can see it functions the same way and you can export presentations in the PowerPoint format (.ppt)
- **CLASS PARTICIPATION:** There really isn't much for you to do here with the online async format. That said, I do like to hear from students. Please reach out to me with questions and/or schedule office hours. Additionally, I will post a couple of discussion boards for students to use. I realize that discussion boards are not a widely used feature for students but they are a good tool. I will open general question threads for each unit and exam. An active discussion board would pretty well guarantee success for all students in this class.
- **QUIZZES AND EXAMS:** You will be given online quizzes each week. These will be specific to the content (reading and videos) for that week. Each quiz will have a total of 10 multiple choice questions and have a ten-minute window for completion. These are not meant to be overly complex, but they will absolutely require you to be familiar with the content provided that week. I'm sure there will be students who take these quizzes hoping to find the material in the reading as they go. While this could be a successful strategy you should bear in mind that 1) these are the primary source of points for this class, 2) the quizzes are timed, and 3) there are no retakes (1 attempt). The reading isn't too complicated and the videos are short. I strongly encourage students to properly prepare before taking each quiz.

There will be three “**Exams**” in this course. For each exam students are asked to create a PowerPoint lecture on a specific topic. These lectures must range from 15-20 slides, include images which support the content of each slide, and include presenter notes (at least a paragraph per slide) which provides a more thorough explanation of the material in the slide and/or the primary purpose of the slide. Check the important documents module on our course website to find a specific breakdown of how to navigate these assignments.

Important: Exams for each unit will open up at the start of each unit. Given that this is a “project based” format, students are given the entire unit to work on their presentations. The topic list will be provided at the start of each unit.

Grading

There are 120 possible points and their distribution is as follows:

Exam 1	20
Exam 2	20
Exam 3	20
Quizzes (n=14)	<u>140</u>

TOTAL 200

Grade	Percentage	Grade	Percentage
A+	98-100	A	90-97
B+	87-89	B	80-86
C+	77-79	C	70-76
D+	67-69	D	60-66
		F	59 or lower

Plagiarism.

It is expected that all assignments submitted for academic credit will be the student's own. In writing, students should be careful to use their own words. Quotations must be placed properly within quotation marks and must be cited fully. Students who are in any doubt about the preparation of their assignment should consult their instructor and TA. Students who, for whatever reason, submit work either not their own or without clear attribution to its sources will be subject to disciplinary action. Any student who submits work provided by AI, a commercial tutoring school, or a term paper company is also subject to disciplinary action.

FERPA law compliance. This course space is being shared by students in the following CRNs [81221, 82363, 82364, 82365, 82366, 82367] and if you do not wish to be in a shared course space, please drop this section and register for another section or alternate course.

Class Schedule and Reading Assignments

PART ONE HUMAN EVOLUTION

Week 1 8/24-08/29	What is Evolution? -Reading: -Textbook: Ch. 2 & Ch. 4 -Course Webpage: Wk. 1 -Quiz #1
Week 2 8/30-9/05	Humans as Primates/Primate Diversity -Reading: -Textbook: Ch. 5 & Ch. 6 -Course Webpage: Wk. 2 -Quiz #2
Week 3 9/06-9/12	Paleoanthropology -Reading: -Textbook: Ch. 7 -Course Webpage: Wk. 3 -Quiz #3
Week 4 9/13-9/19	Early Hominins and the rise of the Genus <i>Homo</i> -Reading: -Textbook: Ch. 9 & Ch. 10 -Course Webpage: Wk. 4 -Quiz #4
Week 5 9/20-9/26	Neanderthals, Denisovans, and <i>Homo sapiens</i> -Reading: -Textbook: Ch. 10, Ch. 11, & Ch. 12 -Course Webpage: Wk. 5 -Quiz #5
Week 6 9/27-10/03	Exam 1

PART TWO THE ARCHAEOLOGY OF HUMAN MIGRATIONS

Week 7 10/04-10/10	Understanding Time: Establishing a Temporal Context -Reading: -Textbook: Ch. 7: Dating Methods -Course Webpage: Wk. 7 -Quiz #6
Week 8 10/11-10/17	Understanding Climate: Establishing an Environmental Context -Reading: -Textbook: Ch. 7: Environmental Reconstruction -Course Webpage: Wk. 8 -Quiz #7
Week 9 10/18-10/24	Migrations out of Africa -Reading: -Textbook: TBD -Course Webpage: Wk. 9 -Quiz #8
Week 10 10/25-10/31	Peopling of North America -Reading: -Textbook: TBD -Course Webpage: Wk. 10 -Quiz #9
Week 11 11/01-11/07	Peopling of Polynesia -Reading: -Textbook: TBD -Course Webpage: Wk. 11 -Quiz #10
Week 12 11/08-11/14	Exam 2

PART 3 COMPLEX SOCIETIES: MESOPOTAMIA AND HAWAI'I

Week 13 Classification in Archaeology
11/15-11/21 -Reading:
 -Textbook: TBD
 -Course Webpage: Wk. 13

-Quiz #11

Week 14 The Neolithic Revolution
11/22-11/28 -Reading:
 -Textbook: TBD
 -Course Webpage: Wk. 14

-Quiz #12

Week 15 Social Complexity in Mesopotamia
11/29-12/05 -Reading:
 -Textbook: TBD
 -Course Webpage: Wk. 15

-Quiz #13

Week 16 The Hawaiian Archaic State
12/06-12/12 -Reading:
 -Textbook: TBD
 -Course Webpage: Wk. 16

-Quiz #14

Week 17 Final Exam
12/13-12/19

Learning Outcomes

- 1) Students will learn to critically evaluate and explain the process of human evolution.
- 2) Students will gain a global perspective on the rise and fall of ancient complex societies.
- 3) Students will learn how to apply their knowledge of ancient societies to current issues in the modern world.
- 4) Students will gain an appreciation for cultural diversity and how this diversity arose.